

Complaints about AI company water usage

Posted by u/ThePinkFxxxx • • 0 points • 55 comments

I recently looked into how much water OpenAI uses daily to cool its AI models (discounting indirect water use from electricity generation, especially from fossil fuel and hydro plants which is separate), and the figure is around 230,000 gallons a day. While that number may sound large, especially considering it's used primarily for accessing information or creating fun images, it's important to put this in perspective.

For comparison, I checked how much water a single water park, such as Great Wolf Lodge, uses each day. One park alone uses roughly 150,000 gallons of water daily. Now, consider the Wisconsin Dells, a region with around 20 such water parks. That's an enormous amount of water used solely for recreation, and that's just one region in one state.

This comparison highlights something strange. For many years, people have consumed vast amounts of water purely for entertainment at water parks, yet there hasn't been widespread criticism. However, with the rise of AI, there's suddenly significant concern about water use tied to technology even though the water consumption by all AI models combined is vastly overshadowed by the total used by water parks across America.

While I'm fully supportive of environmental conservation efforts, it strikes me as inconsistent that people criticize AI companies heavily for their water consumption yet overlook recreational facilities that consume even greater amounts of water.

Also, I acknowledge that the electricity required for AI models, particularly when not sourced from clean energy, can harm the environment. But that's a slightly different issue from water usage. And notably, major AI companies like OpenAI and Google have proactively committed and signed contracts for expanding nuclear power facilities in the coming years, paving the way toward clean, sustainable energy sources to run their models on.

Anyway, if you are going to complain about people using AI models that use lots of water to cool servers, don't be a hypocrite and attend water theme parks and such. And maybe consider why you didn't or don't complain about the water usage at theme parks or anywhere else other than AI company usage.

Comments

u/AcanthaceaeMost3528 • 1 points • 2025-07-12 14:41 UTC

the U.K is currently suffering water shortages ,but the government still allow A.I and other high usage industries to waste our water

u/SourceAddiction • 1 points • 2025-05-13 13:56 UTC

I may be wrong but isn't water used for cooling in computing held in a closed system that prevents evaporation, and then is returned to the environment, albeit in a slightly warmer state than when it entered the system? Water used for cooling is not 'consumed'.

u/AdvertisingNearby110 • 1 points • 2025-05-13 13:35 UTC

If creating Rule 34 images of Ashley Graves means less water for villages in Ethiopia, then so be it.

u/the_bedelgeuse • 2 points • 2025-05-13 11:57 UTC

also anyone who eats meat and also complains about AI water use can honestly STFU. AI is a drop in the ocean compared to animal agriculture. But yall keep smashing double cheeseburgers in 90 seconds while shitposting about AI.